

1.1 What is a Virus?



Life as we know it today would be handicapped without computers. From basic communication, finances and even medical science, computers control just about everything that life in a modern society depends upon. In the ideal world, man would respect such power and work towards bettering it to progression as a civilisation. Unfortunately, that ideal world does not exist, which is why great breakthroughs are often followed by people who are hell-bent on bringing it all down. These people only see weaknesses of an innovation in technology and will go any lengths to exploit it, simply because they can. These are the people who create viruses.

A computer virus can be defined as an executable program that is capable of infecting other computer programs by modifying them to include a copy of itself. Just the way people can spread the common cold by being in contact with other people, a computer virus comes in contact with other programs to 'infect' them. By infecting programs, the virus is capable of spreading through an entire network of computers, infecting every machine that's incapable of protecting itself. While doing so, it could do a world